



Executive Wellness Protocol Templates

Your essential protocols at a glance. Science-backed performance frameworks designed for busy executives who demand results. These proven systems optimize your most valuable asset—yourself—for sustained peak performance.





The S.L.E.E.P. Protocol

Sleep is the foundation of executive performance. This protocol transforms your rest into a strategic advantage, optimizing the 7-9 hours that determine your next day's mental clarity, decision-making capacity, and energy reserves.

S - Set a Schedule

Consistent bedtime: ____
PM

Consistent wake time: ____
AM

7-9 hours target window

No variance on weekends

E - Engineer Environment

Temperature: 65-68°F (18-20°C)

Darkness: Blackout curtains or sleep mask

Quiet: White noise or earplugs if needed

Remove all screens from bedroom

P - Prioritize Sunlight

Get 10-30 minutes of morning sunlight within 1 hour of waking

Avoid bright lights 2-3 hours before bed

Use blue light filters after sunset

L - Limit Stimulants

Caffeine cutoff: ____ PM (8-10 hours before bed)

Alcohol limit: 1-2 drinks max, 3+ hours before bed

No nicotine within 4 hours of sleep

E - Establish Routine

30-60 minute wind-down routine

Dim lights 2 hours before bed

No screens 60 minutes before bed

Relaxing activities: reading, stretching, meditation

☐ **Daily Check:** Did I follow all 5 elements today? ☐

The Flow Activation Protocol

Flow states represent your highest level of cognitive performance—up to 500% productivity gains according to research. This protocol provides a repeatable framework for accessing peak performance on demand, turning deep work from accident into architecture.

01

Pre-Flow Preparation (15 minutes)

Clear distractions: Phone off, notifications silenced

Set clear goal: What will I accomplish in this session?

Optimize environment: Comfortable temperature, good lighting

Prime your state: 5 minutes of breathwork or movement

02

Flow Triggers

Challenge-skill balance: Task is 4% beyond current ability

Clear goals: Know exactly what success looks like

Immediate feedback: Can see progress in real-time

Deep focus: Single-task, no multitasking

03

Maintaining Flow (60-90 minutes)

Work in 60-90 minute blocks with no interruptions allowed

Stay hydrated throughout the session

Maintain slight physical discomfort (standing, cool temperature)

04

Post-Flow Recovery (10 minutes)

Document insights immediately while fresh

Light movement or stretching to reset

Hydrate and refuel your body

Plan next flow session

Best times for flow: _____

The Stress Inoculation Protocol

Like a vaccine strengthens your immune system, controlled stress exposure builds psychological resilience. This protocol systematically expands your capacity to handle pressure, transforming stress from threat to tool. Elite performers don't avoid stress—they train for it.

1	Phase 1: Preparation Identify your stressor (cold exposure, HIIT, public speaking, etc.) Set a specific, measurable goal Schedule your exposure session Prepare recovery protocol
2	Phase 2: Exposure Start small and build gradually. Week 1-2: Low intensity, short duration. Week 3-4: Moderate intensity, medium duration. Week 5+: High intensity, full duration. Example - Cold Exposure: Week 1: 30 seconds cold shower, Week 2: 1 minute, Week 3: 2 minutes, Week 4+: 3-5 minutes cold plunge
3	Phase 3: Recovery Controlled breathing (box breathing: 4-4-4-4) Positive self-talk: "I can handle this" Immediate warm-up or cool-down Journal the experience
4	Phase 4: Reflection How did I respond to the stressor? What coping strategies worked? How can I apply this to work stress?

My chosen stressor: _____ Current level: _____



The Energy Portfolio Model

Energy, not time, is your most precious resource. This model treats your energy like a financial portfolio—with four distinct accounts requiring strategic deposits and careful management of withdrawals. Peak performers actively manage all four dimensions daily.



Physical Energy

Deposits: 7-9 hours quality sleep, nutrient-dense meals every 3-4 hours, 30+ minutes daily movement, proper hydration (½ bodyweight in oz)

Withdrawals: Poor sleep, processed foods and sugar crashes, sedentary lifestyle, dehydration

Current balance: ____ / 10



Emotional Energy

Deposits: Positive social connections, gratitude practice, laughter and play, acts of kindness

Withdrawals: Toxic relationships, chronic negativity, isolation, unresolved conflicts

Current balance: ____ / 10



Mental Energy

Deposits: Deep work sessions, learning new skills, strategic thinking time, meditation

Withdrawals: Constant multitasking, decision fatigue, information overload, lack of breaks

Current balance: ____ / 10



Spiritual Energy

Deposits: Purpose-driven work, alignment with values, contribution to others, time in nature

Withdrawals: Meaningless tasks, values conflicts, pure self-focus, disconnection from purpose

Current balance: ____ / 10

The Three Breathwork Protocols

Your breath is the fastest, most accessible tool for nervous system regulation. These three protocols give you pharmaceutical-grade effects without side effects—shifting from stress to calm, anxiety to peace, fatigue to energy in minutes.

Box Breathing (Calm & Focus)

Use for: Stress reduction, pre-meeting calm, better sleep

Pattern: Inhale through nose (4 counts) → Hold (4 counts) → Exhale through mouth (4 counts) → Hold (4 counts) → Repeat for 5-10 minutes

Best time: Before high-stress situations, before bed

4-7-8 Breathing (Deep Relaxation)

Use for: Anxiety, insomnia, panic attacks

Pattern: Inhale through nose (4 counts) → Hold (7 counts) → Exhale through mouth (8 counts) → Repeat for 4-8 cycles

Best time: Bedtime, after stressful events

Wim Hof Method (Energy & Performance)

Use for: Morning activation, pre-workout, immune boost

Pattern: Take 30-40 deep breaths (inhale fully, exhale naturally) → After last exhale, hold breath as long as comfortable → Inhale fully and hold for 15 seconds → Repeat for 3-4 rounds

Best time: Morning, before cold exposure

Warning: Never do this in water or while driving



The Recovery Acceleration System

Elite athletes know that gains happen during recovery, not training. The same applies to executives—your adaptation, growth, and performance improvements occur when you rest strategically. This system ensures you recover as hard as you work, preventing burnout while maximizing output.

Daily Recovery (Non-Negotiable)

- Sleep: 7-9 hours, consistent schedule
- Nutrition: Protein within 30 min post-workout
- Hydration: ½ bodyweight in oz of water
- Movement: 10-minute walk after meals

Weekly Recovery (Choose 2-3)

- Active recovery: Yoga, swimming, light cycling (60 min)
- Massage: Professional or self-myofascial release (30 min)
- Sauna: 15-20 minutes at 170-190°F
- Cold exposure: 2-5 minutes cold plunge or shower

Monthly Recovery (Choose 1)

- Full rest day: No structured exercise, focus on sleep
- Nature immersion: 2+ hours in natural environment
- Social connection: Quality time with loved ones
- Creative play: Non-work activity purely for joy

Quarterly Recovery (Essential)

- 3-7 day break: From intense training or work projects
- Assessment: Review progress, adjust protocols
- Planning: Set next quarter goals
- Celebration: Acknowledge wins and growth

My recovery schedule:

Daily: _____

Weekly: _____

Monthly: _____



The Quantified Wellness System

What gets measured gets managed. This system transforms wellness from vague intention into precise science, giving you the data needed to optimize your protocols systematically. Top executives treat their bodies like billion-dollar assets –tracked, measured, and continuously improved.



Sleep Metrics

Track total sleep time, sleep quality (1-10 subjective rating), time to fall asleep, and number of wake-ups.

Tool: Oura Ring, Whoop, Apple Watch



Energy Metrics

Monitor morning energy level (1-10), afternoon energy level (1-10), and energy crashes (time and trigger).

Tool: Daily journal, 90-Day Tracker



Performance Metrics

Record focused work hours, deep work sessions completed, and key results achieved.

Tool: Time tracking app, calendar review



Stress Metrics

Measure resting heart rate, heart rate variability (HRV), and subjective stress level (1-10).

Tool: Wearable device, daily check-in



Physical Metrics

Track body composition (not just weight), workout performance, and recovery time.

Tool: Smart scale, workout log

Weekly Review Questions

1. Which metrics improved this week?
2. Which metrics declined?
3. What patterns do I notice?
4. What one thing will I adjust?

My top 3 metrics to track: _____

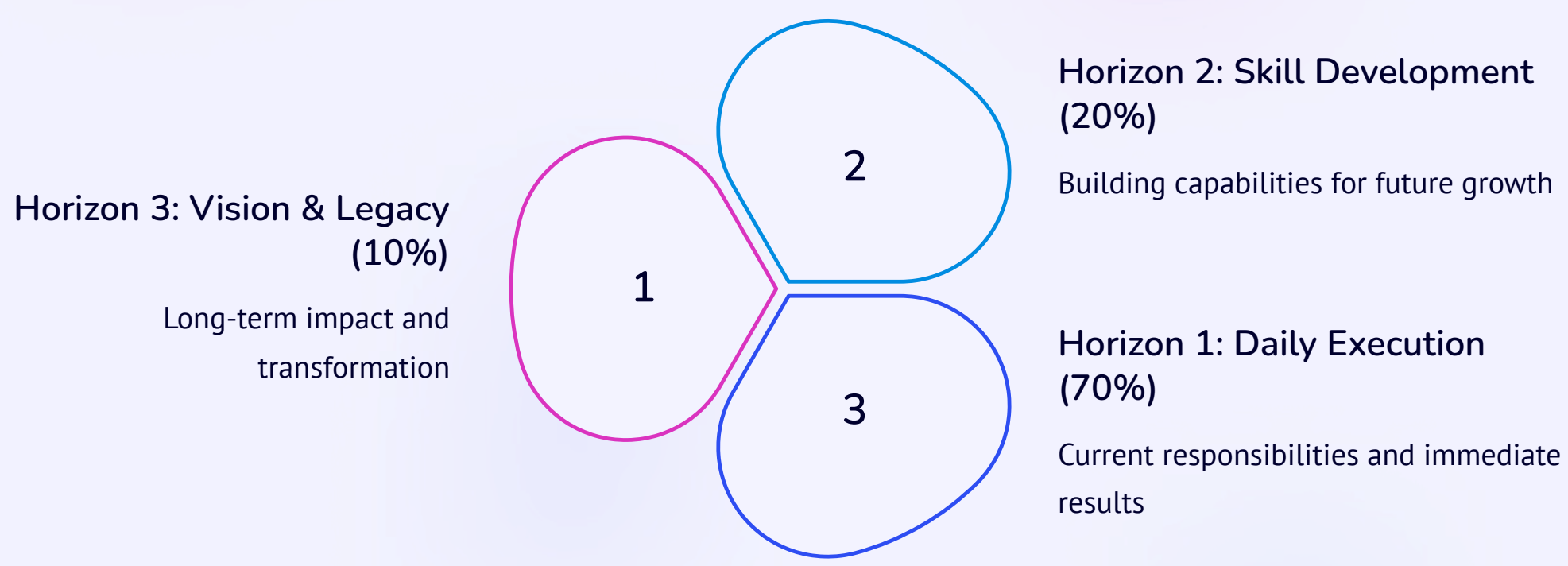
Monthly Optimization

- Calculate averages for all metrics
- Identify your highest-leverage intervention
- Run a 30-day experiment
- Measure results



The Three-Horizon Performance Model

Sustainable excellence requires operating on three time horizons simultaneously. This model prevents the common trap of sacrificing tomorrow for today or becoming so future-focused that current execution suffers. Balance all three horizons and you build a career that compounds.



1

Horizon 1: Daily Execution

Focus: Current responsibilities and immediate results

Key Activities: Existing projects and deliverables, team management and communication, problem-solving and firefighting, maintaining current performance

Daily Question: What must I execute today?

☐

Weekly Time Allocation Check

Horizon 1: ____ hours (target: 70%)

Horizon 2: ____ hours (target: 20%)

Horizon 3: ____ hours (target: 10%)

Am I balanced across all three horizons? ☐

2

Horizon 2: Skill Development

Focus: Building capabilities for future growth

Key Activities: Learning new skills, building relationships, strategic planning, process improvements

Weekly Question: What am I building for next quarter?

3

Horizon 3: Vision & Legacy

Focus: Long-term impact and transformation

Key Activities: Defining your purpose, long-term goal setting, mentoring others, creating lasting value

Monthly Question: What legacy am I creating?

Protocol Implementation Framework

Having elite protocols means nothing without systematic implementation. This framework ensures these tools move from page to practice, becoming automatic habits rather than occasional experiments. Implementation is where knowledge transforms into competitive advantage.



Success Indicators

- Consistent 7+ hours of quality sleep
- 2+ flow states per week
- HRV trending upward
- Sustained energy without stimulants
- Clear progress on Horizon 2 & 3 goals

Common Obstacles

- Trying to implement everything at once
- Skipping tracking and measurement
- Abandoning protocols after one bad day
- Not scheduling protocols in calendar
- Lack of accountability system



Your 30-Day Executive Wellness Challenge

Knowledge without action is merely entertainment. This 30-day challenge transforms these protocols from interesting concepts into lived experience. Commit to one month of consistent implementation and you'll never go back to your old patterns.

Days 1-7

Focus: S.L.E.E.P. Protocol

Set consistent sleep/wake times. Engineer your environment. Track sleep quality daily. No exceptions.

Days 8-14

Add: Daily breathwork

Box breathing before critical meetings. 4-7-8 breathing before sleep. Track stress levels.

Days 15-21

Add: Flow Protocol

Schedule 3 flow sessions this week. Eliminate distractions. Document results.

Days 22-30

Add: Full system integration

Energy Portfolio assessment. Begin stress inoculation. Weekly review. Lock in habits.

●●○○○ 30

Days to transformation

One month of focused implementation creates lasting change

○○○○○ 7

Protocols to master

Comprehensive system for peak executive performance

●●●●● 500%

Potential productivity gain

Research-backed performance increase in flow states

☐

Accountability Partner: Share this challenge with a colleague and check in weekly. Public commitment increases success rates by 65%.

Your Executive Wellness Command Center

This is your mission control—a single-page dashboard for tracking all protocols simultaneously. Print this card, laminate it, and keep it visible. Review daily. The most successful executives treat their wellness with the same rigor as their quarterly earnings. Your protocols are now activated. Execute with precision.



S.L.E.E.P. Protocol Daily Checklist

Schedule consistent ☒ | Stimulants limited ☒ | Environment optimized ☒ | Routine established ☒ | Sunlight prioritized ☒



Flow Sessions This Week

Session 1: ____ | Session 2: ____ | Session 3: ____ | Total focused hours: ____



Energy Portfolio Balance

Physical: ____/10 | Emotional: ____/10 | Mental: ____/10 | Spiritual: ____/10



Stress Inoculation Progress

Current stressor: ____ | This week's target: ____ | Completed ☒



Recovery This Week

Daily recovery: ____ | Weekly modality: ____ | Sleep quality: ____/10



Three-Horizon Time Allocation

H1 (70%): ____hrs | H2 (20%): ____hrs | H3 (10%): ____hrs | Balanced ☒

Weekly Review Questions

1. Which protocol showed the most improvement?
2. Where did I struggle this week?
3. What's my one optimization for next week?
4. Am I tracking my key metrics?

Emergency Protocols

High stress: Box breathing (5 min)

Low energy: Wim Hof breathing

Can't sleep: 4-7-8 breathing

Pre-performance: Flow activation

Elite performance is a system, not an accident.